

Development Feasibility & Site Intelligence Report

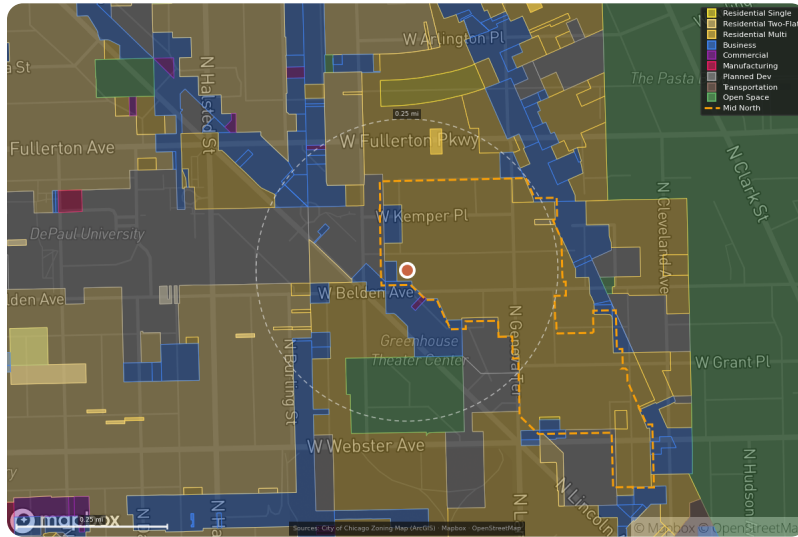
642 W Belden Ave

Lincoln Park Community Area

Development surplus: 4,750 sq ft of additional buildable area beyond existing 1,950 sq ft structure.

DEVELOPMENT SNAPSHOT	
LOT SIZE 3,350 sq ft	ZONING RM-5
MAX BUILDABLE (FAR-BASED, GROSS) 6,700 sq ft	NEARBY SALES (MEDIAN) \$618K · n=4
KEY CONSTRAINT No major constraints flagged	APPROVAL PATH Complex · 3-6 months for permit review

Snapshot of key feasibility metrics — see the report body for sources, assumptions, and limitations. Figures marked "n/a" are unavailable in public data for this parcel.



PIN: [14331030110000](#)

Coordinates: 41.92395, -87.64558

Report Date: June 12, 2026

Generated by UrbanLayer — [urbanlayerchicago.com](#)

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Executive Summary

Site Assessment

CLEAR **Zoning** Base zoning permits development

RISK **Regulatory** Historic/Landmark review required

CLEAR **Environmental** No flood/brownfield risk

FAVORABLE **Financial** Incentives available ([TIF](#))

CLEAR **Site Condition** No open violations

COMPLEX **Approval** Discretionary approval process (3-6 months for permit review)

Development Potential

Maximum buildable: 6,700 sq ft | Surplus: 4,750 sq ft | Max [lot coverage](#): 2,010 sq ft

FAR utilization: Existing 1,950 sq ft uses **29%** of the 6,700 sq ft allowed by [FAR](#) 2.0 — 4,750 sq ft below the FAR cap, typically realized through addition or redevelopment.

Indicative unit capacity (screening estimate): up to ~8 dwelling units total (3,350 sq ft ÷ 400 sq ft min. lot area per unit, RM-5 per Title 17-2-0303), assuming redevelopment of any existing structure. This is a density screen, **not a zoning determination** — permitted units are further limited by minimum lot area, rear-yard open space, FAR, height, parking, and unit mix.

Opportunities & Constraints

▲ **Under-improved property (29% of allowed density)** — Existing 1,950 sq ft uses 29% of the 6,700 sq ft allowed. Significant expansion or teardown-rebuild potential.

▲ **Pre-zoning building (built 1888)** — Structure predates Chicago's 1957 comprehensive zoning code. Existing use and dimensions may be legally nonconforming ('grandfathered'). Verify conformity status before planning modifications.

▲ **Walkable transit corridor (Walk Score 95)** — High walkability + transit access supports reduced-parking or car-free residential development.

▲ **Active development corridor (10 new construction permits nearby)** — High nearby construction activity indicates market confidence, established contractor availability, and favorable zoning precedent.

Zoning & Development Standards

ZONE CLASS

RM-5 — Residential Multi-Unit (FAR 2.0)

Base-district standards from the Title 17 zone-class reference table. Setbacks, parking, and special-use details are not enumerated here — verify site-specific requirements with the City of Chicago Zoning Division.

Bulk & Density Standards

PARAMETER	VALUE
Floor Area Ratio (FAR) — total floor area ÷ lot area	2.0
Maximum Height	45 ft
Lot Coverage — max % of lot covered by structures	60%

Setbacks — min. distance from property line to building

DIRECTION	MINIMUM (FT)
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Development Envelope Summary

On this 3,350 sq ft lot, RM-5 allows up to 6,700 sq ft of floor area up to 45 ft. Maximum building footprint: approximately 2,010 sq ft (60% lot coverage). Permitted uses include: Detached houses, two-flats, townhouses, multi-unit buildings, parks, schools, community centers.

Reflects base district standards only. Overlays, planned developments, transition zones, and site-specific conditions may alter these parameters.

Permitted Uses

Detached houses, two-flats, townhouses, multi-unit buildings, parks, schools, community centers

Notes & Conditions

- Moderate-density multi-unit.
- Standards from the deterministic Title 17 zone-class reference table (base district only), not site-specific code extraction. Overlays, planned developments, and transition zones may alter these. Verify with the City of Chicago Zoning Division.

Adjacent Zoning

N	S	E	W
RM-5 (Residential Multi-Unit (FAR 2.0))	B3-2 (Community Shopping (FAR 2.2))	RM-5 (Residential Multi-Unit (FAR 2.0))	PD 158 (Planned Development (site-specific standards))

▲ Transition zone setback may apply (Title 17-2-0303) at S (B3-2) boundary — residential/commercial interface requires additional setback verification.

Regulatory & Environmental

Overlay & Special Districts

✓ Mid North [Historic Districts]	✓ Individual Landmark Buildings
✓ Transit-Oriented Development (CTA)	✓ ADU Eligible Areas
✓ Affordable Requirements Ordinance Zones	

PLANNED DEVELOPMENT	No
LANDMARK DISTRICT	No
HISTORIC DISTRICT	Yes
NATIONAL REGISTER	No
TOD ELIGIBLE	Yes — CTA rail
ARO ZONE	Yes
SSA	No

Flood Zone (FEMA)

Zone: **X** (AREA OF MINIMAL FLOOD HAZARD)

[ARO](#) Affordable Housing

5 projects, 186 total units in this community area.

Approval Pathway

COMPLEXITY

COMPLEX

PROCESS

Commission on Chicago Landmarks review
required for exterior modifications

ESTIMATED TIMELINE

3-6 months for permit review

Additional requirements:

- ARO affordable housing compliance (if 10+ units)

Timelines are estimates and vary by project specifics and political context.

Property & Physical Characteristics

PIN	14331030110000
BUILDING CLASS	205
BUILDING SQ FT	1,950
LAND SQ FT	3,350
BEDROOMS	4
BATHROOMS	2
YEAR BUILT	1888
BUILDING AGE	138 years (predates current zoning code)
EXTERIOR WALL	Frame
ROOF	Shingle + Asphalt
BASEMENT	Full
GARAGE	0 cars
A/C	No Central A/C
ASSESSED VALUE	\$114,600
EST. MARKET VALUE	\$1,146,000 (assessed ÷ 10% residential level)
EST. ANNUAL TAX	\$23,024
EFFECTIVE TAX RATE	2.0% (of market value)

Parcel Geometry

Parcel geometry unavailable — Cook County GIS did not return boundary data for this property. Land area shown above is from assessor records. For precise lot dimensions, obtain a boundary survey from a licensed surveyor.

Tax Incentive Class: standard — Property class 205 is a standard classification — no tax incentive reduction applies.

Assessment History

YEAR	LAND	BUILDING	TOTAL
2026	\$0	\$0	\$0
2025	\$51,925	\$62,675	\$114,600
2024	\$51,925	\$83,075	\$135,000
2023	\$41,875	\$80,125	\$122,000
2022	\$41,875	\$80,125	\$122,000

Trend: Assessed value decreasing -6.1% over 3 years (2022–2025), -2.1% CAGR. Assessment changes reflect Cook County reassessment cycles, not necessarily market value changes.

Sales History

DATE	PRICE	DEED TYPE
2023-03-20T00:00:00.000	\$1,207,000	Trustee
2018-12-20T00:00:00.000	\$1	Other

Ownership Intelligence

SIGNAL	DETAIL
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Ownership Duration 3 years since last sale (2023-03-20)

What this means for a buyer: The owner has held for several years, so the parcel is likely off-market — expect direct outreach rather than a listed sale, with the owner's basis set a few years back.

Derived from public sales history and tax records. Taxpayer names are not available via open data.

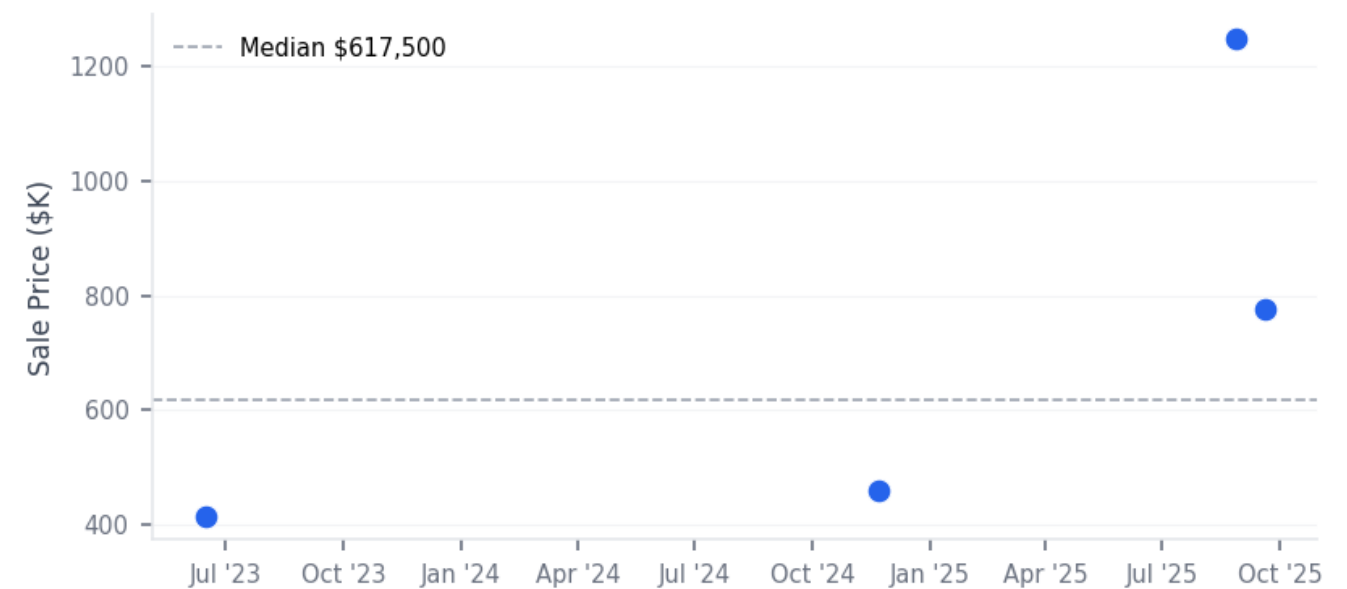
Market Context & Comparables

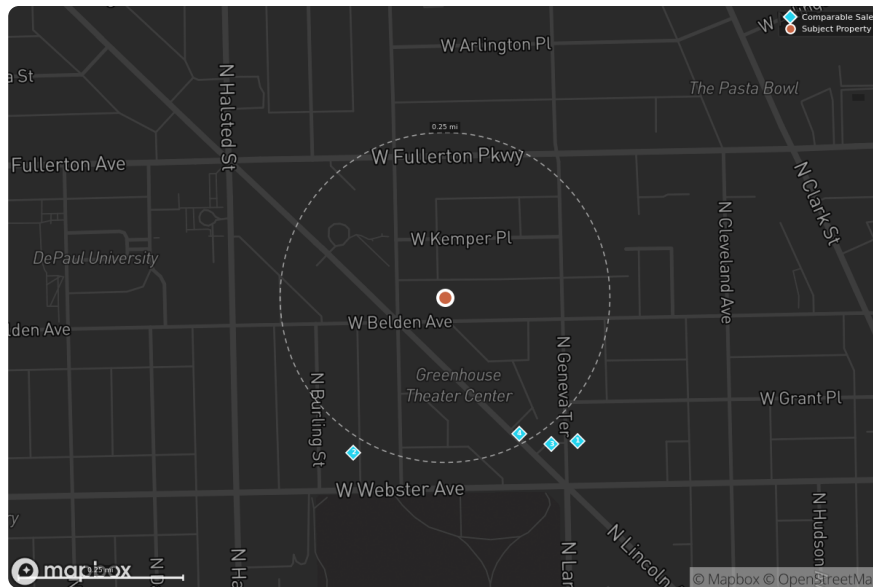
Comparable Sales (4 [arm's-length](#) transactions)

Comparable Market Activity

Median nearby sale: \$617,500 (range \$415,000–\$1,250,000) — Class 2xx sales within 0.28 mi, last 3 yr (n=4)

These are **nearby whole-property sales**, not a valuation of the subject and not land-only value. The comparables' lot size, building size, and condition are not reported in public assessor data, so they are **not size- or condition-matched** to the subject — read them as a market-level price signal only. A lot-normalized land value (per land sq ft) cannot be computed for this market from public data. An independent appraisal is recommended for any transaction decision.





PIN	DATE	PRICE	LAND SF	BLDG SF	\$/BLDG SF	DIST
14331220611002	2025-09-19	\$775,000	—	—	—	0.30 mi
14331150221003	2025-08-27	\$1,250,000	—	—	—	0.27 mi
14331210450000	2024-11-22	\$460,000	—	—	—	0.27 mi
14331210801015	2023-06-16	\$415,000	—	—	—	0.23 mi

95

WALK SCORE

83

TRANSIT SCORE

91

BIKE SCORE

Transit Access

CTA Rail: Fullerton (0.4 mi) — Brown Line, Purple Line, Red Line

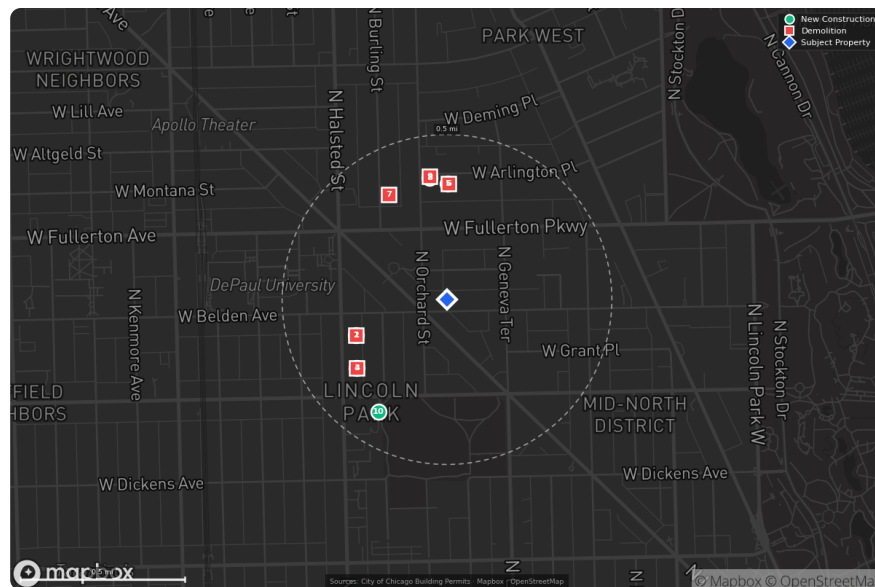
Metra: Clybourn (1.2 mi) — Union Pacific North

Nearby Development Activity (12 months, 0.5mi)

10 new construction permits totaling \$36.7M within 0.5mi in the last 12 months. Average project investment: \$3.7M. 10 demolition permits suggest active site clearance.

#	TYPE	ADDRESS	DESCRIPTION	COST	DATE	DIST
1	New	2219 N FREMONT ST	SC 2019 CBC- FULL PERMIT FOR NEW WALLS (NEW YARD) ...	\$100,000	2026-05-19	0.30 mi

#	TYPE	ADDRESS	DESCRIPTION	COST	DATE	DIST
2	Demo	2219 N FREMONT ST	WRECK AND REMOVE A 3 STORY MASONRY RESIDENCE AND A...	\$206,910	2025-11-24	0.30 mi
3	New	2133 N FREMONT ST	SC 2019 CBC; FULL BUILDING PERMIT FOR NEW CONSTRUC...	\$2,000,000	2026-02-26	0.34 mi
4	Demo	2133 N FREMONT ST	WRECK AND REMOVE A 3 STORY MASONRY MULTI UNIT RESI...	\$64,000	2026-02-24	0.34 mi
5	New	673 W WRIGHTWOOD AVE	DDS 2019 CBC: BELOW-GRADE CONSTRUCTION FOR 4 STORY...	\$500,000	2026-02-27	0.35 mi
6	Demo	671 W WRIGHTWOOD AVE	WRECK AND REMOVE A 2 STORY MASONRY RESIDENCE AND A...	\$86,175	2025-09-09	0.35 mi
7	Demo	2542 N HALSTED ST	WRECK AND REMOVE A 3 STORY MASONRY MIXED USE BUILD...	\$15,000	2025-12-19	0.36 mi
8	New	2604 N ORCHARD ST	SELF-CERT 2019 CBC: NEW CONSTRUCTION OF A (1,407) ...	\$750,000	2026-03-11	0.37 mi
9	Demo	2606 N ORCHARD ST	WRECK AND REMOVE A 2 STORY FRAME RESIDENCE	\$18,000	2026-03-24	0.38 mi
10	New	2029 N DAYTON ST	SELF CERT 2019 CBC: ERECT A 3 STORY VA FRAME SINGL...	\$782,250	2026-02-23	0.40 mi



New construction (green) and demolition (red) permits within 0.5 mi over the past 12 months.

Financial Feasibility & Incentives

TIF DISTRICT	Red and Purple Modernization Phase One Project
OPPORTUNITY ZONE	No
ENTERPRISE ZONE	No
LIHTC QUALIFIED CENSUS TRACT	No
NMTC LOW-INCOME COMMUNITY	No
TAX INCENTIVE CLASS	standard — Property class 205 is a standard classification — no tax incentive reduction applies.

Grant Programs (SBIF / NOF)

1 projects, \$40,062 total funding in this area.

PROJECT	PROGRAM	AMOUNT
Chicago Ballet	SBIF	\$40,062

Tax Estimate

ESTIMATED ANNUAL TAX	\$23,024
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Market value, assessed value, and effective tax rate are detailed under Property & Physical Characteristics.

Tax Breakdown by Agency

AGENCY	RATE	AMOUNT
BOARD OF EDUCATION	3.6310	\$12,631
CITY OF CHICAGO	1.6149	\$5,618
COUNTY OF COOK	0.3905	\$1,358
METRO WATER RECLAMATION DISTRICT OF GREATER CHICAGO	0.3404	\$1,184
CHICAGO PARK DISTRICT	0.2942	\$1,023

Showing top 5 of 9 taxing agencies.

Site Condition & History

No building violations found at this specific address.

311 Complaints at Address (12 months)

6 open complaints

Routine City service requests: Rodent Baiting/Rat Complaint — standard municipal abatement, not a structural or development-feasibility indicator.

50 total complaints in past 12 months (open + closed).

Crime Summary (Last 90 Days — Community Area)

1009 total incidents (6% arrest rate). Overall trend: stable vs. prior year.

Due Diligence Checklist

✓ Completed in This Report

- ✓ Zoning classification & standards
- ✓ Overlay & special district check
- ✓ FEMA flood zone determination
- ✓ EPA brownfield proximity search
- ✓ Property tax & assessment analysis
- ✓ Comparable sales analysis
- ✓ Permit history review
- ✓ Building violation audit

☐ Action Required

- ☐ Title search & commitment
- ☐ ALTA/NSPS land survey
- ☐ Phase I ESA (if warranted)
- ☐ Utility verification (DWM/ComEd)
- ☐ Soil/geotechnical (if new construction)
- ☐ Flood insurance quotes (if applicable)

Recommended Next Steps

Immediate (Blocking Issues)

- Contact the Commission on Chicago Landmarks before any exterior modifications — this property is in a historic district requiring permit review

Due Diligence (Standard Process)

- Request title search from Cook County Recorder of Deeds for recorded easements and encumbrances
- Engage a licensed surveyor for boundary survey and easement identification
- Contact DWM and ComEd for utility location maps
- Check Chicago Legistar for active zoning applications or planned developments affecting this property

Advisory (Optimization)

- Contact the TIF administrator for **Red and Purple Modernization Phase One Project** to discuss available funding for site improvements, infrastructure, or environmental remediation
- Commission an independent appraisal to confirm land value before structuring an offer — public-data comparables are a screening tool, not a valuation

- Validate the as-of-right unit yield (~8 units) with a zoning attorney or expediter, accounting for parking, open-space, and unit-mix rules before underwriting
- Pull broker comparables and a local market study to pressure-test absorption, rents, and exit pricing for the intended product

Glossary

ADU (Accessory Dwelling Unit)

A secondary residential unit on a single-family lot, such as a coach house or basement apartment. Chicago's ADU ordinance allows these in certain zones to increase housing supply.

Arm's-Length Transaction

A sale between unrelated parties acting in their own self-interest, at fair market value. This report excludes non-arm's-length sales (family transfers, foreclosures, sub-\$10K transactions) from comparable analysis.

ARO (Affordable Requirements Ordinance)

Chicago ordinance requiring residential developments of 10+ units receiving city financial assistance or zoning changes to set aside a percentage of units as affordable, or pay a fee into the Affordable Housing Fund.

EZ (Enterprise Zone)

State-designated areas offering tax incentives to encourage business investment and job creation, including sales tax exemptions on building materials, investment tax credits, and utility tax exemptions.

NMTC (New Markets Tax Credit)

Federal program providing 39% tax credit over 7 years for private investment in qualifying low-income communities through Community Development Financial Institutions (CDFIs). Severely distressed tracts receive allocation priority.

OZ (Opportunity Zone)

Federally designated census tracts where investors can receive capital gains tax benefits for long-term investments. Created by the 2017 Tax Cuts and Jobs Act to stimulate economic development in distressed communities.

PD (Planned Development)

A site-specific zoning designation requiring City Council approval. PDs allow flexibility in development standards but add a discretionary review process. Any change to an existing PD requires a new approval.

PIN (Property Index Number)

A 14-digit identifier assigned by the Cook County Assessor to every parcel of real property. Used for tax assessment, title records, and government data systems.

QCT (Qualified Census Tract)

HUD-designated census tract where 50%+ of households earn below 60% of Area Median Income. LIHTC (Low-Income Housing Tax Credit) projects in QCTs receive an enhanced basis boost of up to 130%, making affordable housing development more financially feasible.

SFHA (Special Flood Hazard Area)

FEMA-designated zones with a 1% or greater annual chance of flooding (the "100-year floodplain"). Properties in SFHAs require flood insurance if federally financed and face additional construction requirements.

SSA (Special Service Area)

A defined geographic district where businesses pay an additional property tax to fund enhanced services such as streetscaping, marketing, snow removal, and security beyond standard city services.

TIF (Tax Increment Financing)

A public financing tool that captures the increase in property tax revenue within a designated district over a base year to fund improvements within that district. Chicago TIF districts have a 23-year lifespan.

TOD (Transit-Oriented Development)

Development within a specified distance of a transit station (typically 1/4 mile for bus, 1/2 mile for rail). Chicago's TOD ordinance allows reduced parking requirements and density bonuses near transit.

Zoning District Definitions

Reference standards for all zoning districts cited in this report, sourced from Chicago Municipal Code, Title 17. Values shown are base district standards; overlays, planned developments, and bonuses may modify these limits.

RM-5 — Residential Multi-Unit §17-2-0104 ● [Subject Property](#)

STANDARD	VALUE
Floor Area Ratio (FAR)	2.0
Maximum Height	45 ft
Lot Coverage	60%

Permitted Uses: Detached houses, two-flats, townhouses, multi-unit buildings, parks, schools, community centers
Moderate-density multi-unit.

B3-2 — Community Shopping §17-3-0104

STANDARD	VALUE
Floor Area Ratio (FAR)	2.2
Maximum Height	50 ft (varies by lot frontage)

Permitted Uses: Broad retail, restaurants, services, entertainment, offices; residential above ground floor. Destination-oriented, higher parking.

PD 158 — Planned Development §17-8-0500

Permitted Uses: Standards are site-specific per the approved planned development ordinance.
Planned developments have individually negotiated standards approved by City Council. Consult the specific PD ordinance for FAR, height, use, and setback requirements.

▲ Non-standard or site-specific designation — verify with the City of Chicago Zoning Division.

Data Sources & Disclaimers

Data Sources

CATEGORY	SOURCE	NOTES
Property (parcel, characteristics, assessments, sales)	Cook County Assessor / GIS / Parcel Universe	Triennial assessments; arm's-length comps only
Zoning (classification, standards, overlays, adjacent)	Chicago Zoning MapServer + Municipal Code Title 17	Real-time spatial query; standards AI-extracted
Regulatory (flood, brownfields)	FEMA NFHL / EPA Cleanups in My Community	Real-time queries
Incentives (TIF, OZ, EZ, QCT, NMTC, grants)	City of Chicago / HUD / Census FIPS	Spatial + financial datasets
Demographics & Transit	Census ACS 5-Year / CTA-Metra GTFS / Walk Score	ACS 2019–2023 (2-year lag)
Crime & 311	Chicago Police Dept. / 311 via Data Portal	~7-day lag; 12-month address lookup
Permits & Violations	City of Chicago Building Dept.	Address-specific + nearby activity
Affordable Housing (ARO)	City of Chicago Affordable Housing	Community area projects

Methodology

This report aggregates publicly available government data from multiple sources. Zoning standards are extracted from the indexed Chicago Municipal Code via AI (Claude Haiku) and should be verified against the current ordinance. Property assessments are triennial and may not reflect current market values. Demographics are estimated from ACS 5-year survey data (2019–2023). Comparable sales are filtered for arm's-length transactions only (excluding multi-sales, sub-\$10K, and non-standard deed types). Development potential is calculated as FAR × lot area and does not account for planned development restrictions, variance requirements, or site-specific conditions.

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information. Always consult with a licensed attorney for zoning and land use matters, a licensed appraiser for property valuations, and appropriate city departments for permit and regulatory compliance.

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Report Date: June 12, 2026